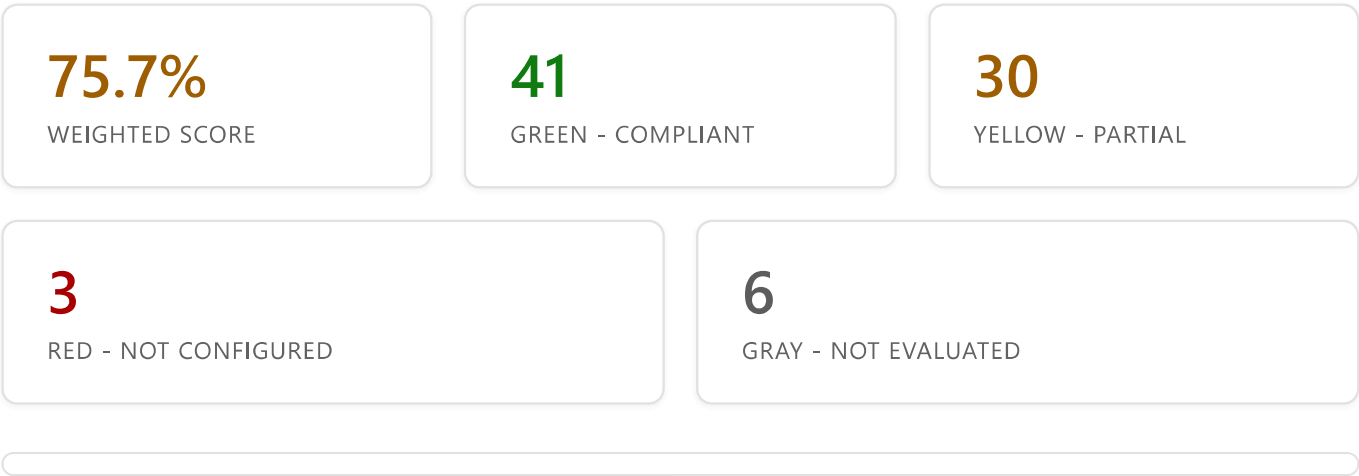


Microsoft Defender & Purview Best Practice Report

Tenant: Unknown tenant | Generated: 2026-08-25 09:37:47 | Runtime: 67s | Cloud: Global



Green - enabled / enforced / blocking

Yellow - partial: audit or warn mode, simulation, report-only, lower tier, or only some objects compliant

Red - off, missing, or not configured **Gray** - could not be evaluated (permissions, module, licensing, or workload skipped)

Defender for Office 365 54 checks · 29 green · 23 yellow · 1 red · 1 gray

SETTING	CATEGORY	STATUS	CURRENT VALUE	EXPECTED	RECOMMENDATION
Outbound spam notification recipients	Anti-spam (outbound)	Red	Recipients set in 0 of 1 policies	Set in all policies	Add a security distribution list so the SOC hears about outbound spam before the recipient domain blocks you.
Advanced phishing threshold	Anti-phishing	Yellow	2 of 3 policies at level 2 or higher	Level 2 (Aggressive) or higher	Raise the advanced phishing threshold to at least 2. Strict preset uses 3.

SETTING	CATEGORY	STATUS	CURRENT VALUE	EXPECTED	RECOMMENDATION
Domain impersonation action	Anti-phishing	Yellow	Quarantine in 2, softer action in 0 of 3	Quarantine	Set "Domain impersonation action" to Quarantine. Move-to-junk leaves the message reachable by the user.
Domain impersonation protection	Anti-phishing	Yellow	Enabled in 2 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Turn on "Domain impersonation protection" in every anti-phishing policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
First contact safety tip	Anti-phishing	Yellow	Enabled in 2 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Turn on "First contact safety tip" in every anti-phishing policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
Mailbox intelligence impersonation action	Anti-phishing	Yellow	Quarantine in 1, softer action in 1 of 3	Quarantine	Set "Mailbox intelligence impersonation action" to Quarantine. Move-to-junk leaves the message reachable by the user.
Mailbox intelligence impersonation protection	Anti-phishing	Yellow	Enabled in 2 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Turn on "Mailbox intelligence impersonation protection" in every anti-phishing policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
Owned-domain impersonation protection	Anti-phishing	Yellow	Enabled in 2 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Turn on "Owned-domain impersonation protection" in every anti-phishing policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
Similar domains safety tip	Anti-phishing	Yellow	Enabled in 2 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Turn on "Similar domains safety tip" in every anti-phishing

SETTING	CATEGORY	STATUS	CURRENT VALUE	EXPECTED	RECOMMENDATION
					policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
Similar users safety tip	Anti-phishing	Yellow	Enabled in 2 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Turn on "Similar users safety tip" in every anti-phishing policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
Spoof detection action	Anti-phishing	Yellow	Quarantine in 1, softer action in 2 of 3	Quarantine	Set "Spoof detection action" to Quarantine. Move-to-junk leaves the message reachable by the user.
Unusual characters safety tip	Anti-phishing	Yellow	Enabled in 2 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Turn on "Unusual characters safety tip" in every anti-phishing policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
User impersonation action	Anti-phishing	Yellow	Quarantine in 2, softer action in 0 of 3	Quarantine	Set "User impersonation action" to Quarantine. Move-to-junk leaves the message reachable by the user.
User impersonation protection	Anti-phishing	Yellow	Enabled in 2 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Turn on "User impersonation protection" in every anti-phishing policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
Bulk complaint level threshold	Anti-spam (inbound)	Yellow	2 of 3 policies at BCL 6 or lower	BCL 6 or lower	Standard preset uses BCL 6, Strict uses 5. Higher values let more bulk mail through.
Bulk mail action	Anti-spam (inbound)	Yellow	Quarantine in 1, junk folder in 2 of 3	Quarantine	Junk folder is acceptable for bulk mail. Quarantine only if your users tolerate it.

SETTING	CATEGORY	STATUS	CURRENT VALUE	EXPECTED	RECOMMENDATION
High-confidence spam action	Anti-spam (inbound)	Yellow	Quarantine in 2, junk folder in 1 of 3	Quarantine	Set "High-confidence spam action" to Quarantine so the message is never reachable from the mailbox.
Phishing verdict action	Anti-spam (inbound)	Yellow	Quarantine in 2, junk folder in 1 of 3	Quarantine	Set "Phishing verdict action" to Quarantine so the message is never reachable from the mailbox.
Quarantine retention period	Anti-spam (inbound)	Yellow	2 of 3 policies retain for 30 days	30 days	Set quarantine retention to the 30-day maximum so investigations are not blocked by expiry.
Spam verdict action	Anti-spam (inbound)	Yellow	Quarantine in 1, junk folder in 2 of 3	Quarantine	Set "Spam verdict action" to Quarantine so the message is never reachable from the mailbox.
External automatic forwarding	Anti-spam (outbound)	Yellow	Off in 0, Automatic in 1 of 1	Off	Set AutoForwardingMode to Off. External auto-forward is the standard exfiltration path after a mailbox compromise.
Apply to internal senders	Safe Links	Yellow	Compliant in 2 of 3 policies	EnableForInternalSenders = True	Set "Apply to internal senders" correctly in every Safe Links policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
Block user click-through	Safe Links	Yellow	Compliant in 2 of 3 policies	AllowClickThrough = False	Set "Block user click-through" correctly in every Safe Links policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
URL rewriting enabled	Safe Links	Yellow	Compliant in 2 of 3	DisableURLRewrite	Set "URL rewriting enabled" correctly in

SETTING	CATEGORY	STATUS	CURRENT VALUE	EXPECTED	RECOMMENDATION
			policies	= False	every Safe Links policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
DKIM signing	Tenant hygiene	Gray	Could not read DKIM configuration	Enabled on all sending domains	Verify Exchange Online read permissions.
Common attachment filter	Anti-malware	Green	Enabled in 3 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Enable the common attachment filter to block executable file types outright.
Malware zero-hour auto purge (ZAP)	Anti-malware	Green	Enabled in 3 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Enable malware ZAP so already-delivered malicious mail is retracted.
Quarantine policy assigned	Anti-malware	Green	Quarantine policy set in 3 of 3 policies	Quarantine policy assigned in all policies	Assign an explicit quarantine policy so end-user release and notification behaviour is deliberate.
DMARC p=quarantine action	Anti-phishing	Green	Quarantine in 3 of 3 policies	Quarantine	Set the DMARC quarantine action to Quarantine rather than junk.
DMARC p=reject action	Anti-phishing	Green	Reject in 3 of 3 policies	Reject	Honour the sending domain's published DMARC policy by setting the reject action to Reject.
Honor DMARC policy	Anti-phishing	Green	Enabled in 3 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Turn on "Honor DMARC policy" in every anti-phishing policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.

SETTING	CATEGORY	STATUS	CURRENT VALUE	EXPECTED	RECOMMENDATION
Mailbox intelligence	Anti-phishing	Green	Enabled in 3 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Turn on "Mailbox intelligence" in every anti-phishing policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
Spoof intelligence	Anti-phishing	Green	Enabled in 3 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Turn on "Spoof intelligence" in every anti-phishing policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
Unauthenticated sender (question mark) indicator	Anti-phishing	Green	Enabled in 3 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Turn on "Unauthenticated sender (question mark) indicator" in every anti-phishing policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
Via tag indicator	Anti-phishing	Green	Enabled in 3 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Turn on "Via tag indicator" in every anti-phishing policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
High-confidence phishing action	Anti-spam (inbound)	Green	Quarantine in all policies	Quarantine	Set "High-confidence phishing action" to Quarantine so the message is never reachable from the mailbox.
Inline safety tips	Anti-spam (inbound)	Green	Enabled in 3 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Keep inline safety tips on - they are a cheap and effective user cue.
Phishing ZAP	Anti-spam (inbound)	Green	Enabled in 3 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Enable ZAP so mail that turns out to be malicious after delivery is pulled back.
Spam ZAP	Anti-spam (inbound)	Green	Enabled in 3 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Enable ZAP so mail that turns out to be malicious after delivery is pulled back.

SETTING	CATEGORY	STATUS	CURRENT VALUE	EXPECTED	RECOMMENDATION
Action when send limit is reached	Anti-spam (outbound)	Green	Blocks the user in 1 of 1 policies	Restrict the user from sending mail	Set the threshold action to restrict the user so a compromised mailbox stops sending immediately.
Defender for Office preset security policy	Preset policies	Green	Strict preset enabled	Standard or Strict enabled	No action required.
EOP preset security policy	Preset policies	Green	Strict preset enabled	Standard or Strict enabled	No action required.
Block Safe Docs click-through	Safe Attachments	Green	AllowSafeDocsOpen = False	False	Set AllowSafeDocsOpen to False so users cannot leave Protected View on a malicious file.
Safe Attachments enabled	Safe Attachments	Green	Enabled in 3 of 3 policies	Enabled in all policies	Enable Safe Attachments in every policy.
Safe Documents	Safe Attachments	Green	EnableSafeDocs = True	True	Enable Safe Documents so files opened in Protected View are scanned before trust is granted.
SharePoint / OneDrive / Teams protection	Safe Attachments	Green	EnableATPForSPOTeamsODB = True	True	Enable Safe Attachments for SharePoint, OneDrive and Teams to catch malware stored in files.
Unknown malware response	Safe Attachments	Green	Block in all policies	Block	Set the Safe Attachments action to Block. Allow/monitor-only delivers unscanned malware to the mailbox.
Real-time URL scanning	Safe Links	Green	Compliant in 3 of 3 policies	ScanUrIs = True	Set "Real-time URL scanning" correctly in every Safe Links policy,

SETTING	CATEGORY	STATUS	CURRENT VALUE	EXPECTED	RECOMMENDATION
					or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
Safe Links for email	Safe Links	Green	Compliant in 3 of 3 policies	EnableSafeLinksForEmail = True	Set "Safe Links for email" correctly in every Safe Links policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
Safe Links for Office 365 apps	Safe Links	Green	Compliant in 3 of 3 policies	EnableSafeLinksForOffice = True	Set "Safe Links for Office 365 apps" correctly in every Safe Links policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
Safe Links for Teams	Safe Links	Green	Compliant in 3 of 3 policies	EnableSafeLinksForTeams = True	Set "Safe Links for Teams" correctly in every Safe Links policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
Track user clicks	Safe Links	Green	Compliant in 3 of 3 policies	TrackClicks = True	Set "Track user clicks" correctly in every Safe Links policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
Wait for scan before delivery	Safe Links	Green	Compliant in 3 of 3 policies	DeliverMessageAfterScan = True	Set "Wait for scan before delivery" correctly in every Safe Links policy, or adopt the Standard/Strict preset.
Mailbox auditing	Tenant hygiene	Green	AuditDisabled = False	AuditDisabled = False	Keep mailbox auditing on. Without it you lose the forensic record after a BEC incident.

Microsoft Purview 26 checks · 12 green · 7 yellow · 2 red · 5 gray

SETTING	CATEGORY	STATUS	CURRENT VALUE	EXPECTED	RECOMMENDATION
Unified audit log ingestion	Audit	Red	UnifiedAuditLogIngestionEnabled = False	True	Turn auditing on in the Purview portal, or run Set-AdminAuditLogConfig -UnifiedAuditLogIngestionEnabled \$true. Without it there is no forensic record to investigate.
Retention label storage created	Retention labels	Red	Label storage not created	Label storage created	Run Enable-ComplianceTagStorage once. Retention labels cannot be used until this one-time storage exists.
DLP incident reports	Data loss prevention	Yellow	Incident report configured on 1 of 15 rules	Incident reports configured	Configure incident reports so DLP matches reach the SOC rather than sitting only in the Purview portal.
DLP policy enforcement mode	Data loss prevention	Yellow	3 enforced, 1 in simulation, 0 disabled (of 4)	Mode = Enable	Policies left in TestWithNotifications or TestWithoutNotifications detect but never block. Review simulation results, then switch Mode to Enable.
DLP rules with blocking action	Data loss prevention	Yellow	0 blocking, 2 of 15 rules notify or alert only	At least one rule with BlockAccess enabled	Notify-only rules build awareness but stop nothing. Set BlockAccess on rules covering your highest-risk sensitive info types.
Policy: Default DLP policy - Protect sensitive M365 Copilot interactions	DLP policy detail	Yellow	Mode = TestWithNotifications	Enable	Move validated policies out of simulation into Enable so the configured actions take effect.
Automatic / recommended labelling	Information protection	Yellow	0 of 12 labels use automatic or	Auto-labelling configured for known	Manual-only labelling depends entirely on user diligence. Add auto-labelling conditions for your key sensitive info types.

SETTING	CATEGORY	STATUS	CURRENT VALUE	EXPECTED	RECOMMENDATION
			recommended labelling	sensitive info types	
Labels applying content marking	Information protection	Yellow	0 of 12 labels apply header, footer or watermark	Sensitive tiers apply visible marking	Visible markings are a cheap behavioural control and make mishandled documents obvious in screenshots and printouts.
Labels applying encryption	Information protection	Yellow	0 of 12 labels apply encryption	Confidential tiers apply encryption	Labels that only apply a visual marking do not protect content outside your tenant. Add encryption to your confidential and highly-confidential tiers.
Custom audit retention policy	Audit	Gray	Could not read audit retention policies	At least one policy retaining high-value activity beyond the default	Verify the account holds an audit read role.
Communication compliance policies	Communication compliance	Gray	Could not read communication compliance policies	At least one active policy	Confirm the account holds a Communication Compliance role.
Retention policy inventory	Data lifecycle	Gray	Could not read retention policies	At least one enforced retention policy	Confirm the account holds a retention management read role.
Insider risk policies	Insider risk	Gray	Could not read insider	At least one	Confirm the account holds an Insider Risk Management role.

SETTING	CATEGORY	STATUS	CURRENT VALUE	EXPECTED	RECOMMENDATION
			risk policies	enabled policy	
Retention label inventory	Retention labels	Gray	Could not read retention labels	Retention labels defined and published	Verify retention read permissions.
DLP coverage: Endpoint DLP (devices)	DLP coverage	Green	Covered by 1 of 4 policies	At least one policy covering this location	Add Endpoint DLP (devices) as a location to a DLP policy, otherwise sensitive data can leave through that channel unchecked.
DLP coverage: Exchange Online	DLP coverage	Green	Covered by 1 of 4 policies	At least one policy covering this location	Add Exchange Online as a location to a DLP policy, otherwise sensitive data can leave through that channel unchecked.
DLP coverage: OneDrive for Business	DLP coverage	Green	Covered by 1 of 4 policies	At least one policy covering this location	Add OneDrive for Business as a location to a DLP policy, otherwise sensitive data can leave through that channel unchecked.
DLP coverage: SharePoint Online	DLP coverage	Green	Covered by 1 of 4 policies	At least one policy covering this location	Add SharePoint Online as a location to a DLP policy, otherwise sensitive data can leave through that channel unchecked.
DLP coverage: Teams chat and channel messages	DLP coverage	Green	Covered by 1 of 4 policies	At least one policy covering this location	Add Teams chat and channel messages as a location to a DLP policy, otherwise sensitive data can leave through that channel unchecked.
Policy: Default Office 365 DLP policy	DLP policy detail	Green	Mode = Enable	Enable	Move validated policies out of simulation into Enable so the configured actions take effect.

SETTING	CATEGORY	STATUS	CURRENT VALUE	EXPECTED	RECOMMENDATION
Policy: Default policy for devices	DLP policy detail	Green	Mode = Enable	Enable	Move validated policies out of simulation into Enable so the configured actions take effect.
Policy: Default policy for Teams	DLP policy detail	Green	Mode = Enable	Enable	Move validated policies out of simulation into Enable so the configured actions take effect.
Default label configured	Information protection	Green	Default label set in 1 of 1 policies	Default label configured	A default label ensures new content starts classified rather than unlabelled.
Mandatory labelling	Information protection	Green	Mandatory labelling detected in 1 of 1 policies	Mandatory labelling enabled	Requiring a label on save or send is the single biggest driver of labelling coverage. Enable it once your taxonomy is stable.
Sensitivity label inventory	Information protection	Green	12 of 12 labels enabled	Labels defined and enabled	Remove or re-enable disabled labels so the taxonomy users see matches what you intend.
Sensitivity label publication	Information protection	Green	1 label policy(ies) published	At least one label policy published to users	Labels that are never published are invisible to users. Publish them to the relevant groups.

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